

Shakked Noy

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EDUCATION	Massachusetts Institute of Technology , Cambridge, MA, United States PhD in Economics, 2022—present Victoria University of Wellington , Wellington, New Zealand Master of Commerce in Economics, 2020 Bachelor of Arts (Honors) in Philosophy, 2021 Bachelor of Science in Mathematics and Economics, 2018	
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Predoctoral Research Assistant for Professors Simon Jäger and Benjamin Schoefer Research Analyst, Motu Economic and Public Policy Research	2020—2022 2020
WORKING PAPERS	“The Supply Side of Social Media” [Job Market Paper] (with Aakaash Rao), 2026 We trace the prevalence of politically extreme and envy-inducing content on social media to social media’s distinctive model of content production. Unlike legacy media outlets, which professionally procure small amounts of content, social media platforms rely on large numbers of predominantly unpaid users supplying content they are intrinsically motivated to produce, and use the resulting production scale to separately cherry-pick the pieces of content that most appeal to each viewer. Collecting observational data and conducting experiments with creators and viewers on Instagram, TikTok, X/Twitter, and YouTube, we show that because creators are not paid, content production is dominated by an unrepresentative minority of users who post enviable “lifestyle” content and extreme political content in pursuit of social status and expressive satisfaction. Post-by-post, enviable or extreme posts are not more likely than benign posts to highly engage a given viewer. But the scale at which enviable and extreme content is produced allows platforms to find a greater number of such posts that will appeal to a given user, due to closely matching the viewer’s interests on other dimensions. The prevalence of negative content on social media hence stems partly from platforms’ reliance on cheaply generating scale through status-, emotion-, and conflict-motivated <i>production</i>. “The Business of the Culture War” [link] (with Aakaash Rao), 2026 We link the contemporary American “culture war” to the entry of 24-hour cable news networks in the 1980s and 1990s. We show that cable news networks emphasize cultural issues more than the broadcast news networks preceding them and far more than politicians, whose campaign advertising overwhelmingly focuses on economic issues. Using household-by-second TV viewership data, we trace cable networks’ cultural emphasis to a distinctive business strategy focused on competing with entertainment programming rather than with rival news networks: whereas economic content is more effective at “poaching” consumers from other news networks, cultural content is far more effective at “mobilizing” consumers who would otherwise not watch news. Cable networks emphasize culture more than <i>broadcast networks</i> because they air news 24 hours a day rather than 1–2 during primetime hours, so their marginal consumers watch more entertainment and less news. Cable networks emphasize culture more than <i>politicians</i> because they face greater incentives to mobilize new attention: while politicians similarly trade off mobilizing new voters against poaching opponents’ voters, politicians maximize their vote <i>share</i> rather than audience <i>size</i> and thus value poaching twice as much as mobilizing. Cable’s unique incentives to center cultural issues influence politics: constituencies more exposed to cable news assign greater importance to cultural issues, and politicians respond by supplying more	

cultural advertisements.

“The Transmission of Reliable and Unreliable Information” [link]

(with Thomas Graeber and Chris Roth), 2026; accepted, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*

Information often spreads and influences beliefs regardless of its reliability. We show that this occurs in part because indicators of reliability tend to be lost in the process of word-of-mouth transmission. We conduct controlled experiments where participants listen to economic forecasts and pass them on through voice messages. Other participants listen either to original or transmitted audio recordings and report incentivized beliefs. Across various transmitter incentive schemes, a claim’s reliability is lost in transmission much more than the claim itself. Reliable and unreliable information, once filtered through transmission, impact listener beliefs similarly. Mechanism experiments show that reliability is lost not because it is perceived as less relevant or harder to transmit, but because it is less likely to *come to mind* during transmission. Evidence from our experiments, a large corpus of everyday conversations, and economic TV news shows that contextual cues can bring reliability to mind and induce its transmission, but situations in which people share information seldom contain such cues.

PUBLICATIONS

“Experimental Evidence on the Productivity Effects of Generative Artificial Intelligence” [link]

(with Whitney Zhang), *Science*, 2023

We examined the productivity effects of a generative artificial intelligence technology—the assistive chatbot ChatGPT—in the context of mid-level professional writing tasks. In a preregistered online experiment, we assigned occupation-specific, incentivized writing tasks to 453 college-educated professionals, and randomly exposed half of them to ChatGPT. Our results show that ChatGPT substantially raised productivity: average time taken decreased by 40% and output quality rose by 18%. Inequality between workers decreased, and concern and excitement about AI temporarily rose. Workers exposed to ChatGPT during the experiment were $2\times$ as likely to report using it in their real job two weeks after the experiment, and $1.6\times$ as likely two months after the experiment.

“The German Model of Industrial Relations: Balancing Flexibility and Collective Action” [link]

(with Simon Jäger and Benjamin Schoefer), *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 2022

We give an overview of the two pillars of the “German model” of industrial relations: sectoral collective bargaining and firm-level codetermination. Relative to the United States, Germany outsources collective bargaining to the sectoral level, resulting in higher coverage and the avoidance of firm-level distributional conflict. Relative to other European countries, Germany makes it easy for employers to avoid coverage or use flexibility provisions to deviate downwards from collective agreements. The greater flexibility of the German system may reduce unemployment, but may also erode bargaining coverage and increase inequality. Meanwhile, firm-level codetermination through worker board representation and works councils creates cooperative dialogue between employers and workers. Board representation has few direct impacts owing to worker representatives’ minority vote share, but works councils, which hold a range of substantive powers, may be more impactful. Overall, the German model highlights tensions between efficiency-enhancing flexibility and equity-enhancing collective action.

“The Effects of Neighborhood and Workplace Income Comparisons on Subjective Wellbeing” [link]

(with Isabelle Sin), *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, 2021

We investigate how a person’s happiness is affected by the incomes of her neighbors and coworkers. Using an unprecedentedly rich combination of administrative and survey data, we establish two central results. First, a person’s happiness is sensitive to her ordinal rank within her peer income distribution: people are happier the higher their income rank. Second, workplace rank matters much more than neighborhood rank. We confirm that our results reflect a causal effect of peer income by implementing sensitivity analyses, identifying off changes in peer income over time for immobile people, exploiting plausibly exogenous moves between workplaces triggered by mass layoffs, and testing for the effects of unobservable group-level confounders.

TEACHING	Behavioral Economics (PhD, MIT course 14.160) Teaching Assistant for Professors Frank Schilbach and Abhijit Banerjee [link to evaluations]	2025
AWARDS AND GRANTS	Jerry A. Hausman Graduate Dissertation Fellowship	2025
	Humane Studies Fellowship	2025
	Emergent Ventures Grant	2023
	Jan Whitwell Prize	2021
	Seamus Hogan Prize	2021
	Maurice Goldsmith Prize	2021
	MacMorran Prize in Mathematics	2017
	JT Campbell Prize in Statistics	2017
	SEF Prize in Second-Year Macroeconomics	2017
PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES	<i>Conference Presentations</i>	
	Early-Career Behavioral Economists Conference (Chicago)	2026
	Behavioral Economics Annual Meeting (JMC workshop)	2026
	Early-Career Behavioral Economists Conference (Bonn)	2024
	Chicago Booth Generative AI & Labor Mini-Conference	2024
	CESifo Behavioral Economics	2023
	NBER SI Digital Economics and Artificial Intelligence (lightning talk)	2023
	<i>Summer Schools</i>	
	Consortium on the American Political Economy Summer Academy	2024
	briq Summer School in Behavioral Economics	2023
	IZA Summer School in Labor Economics	2023
	<i>Service</i>	
	Co-organizer, MIT Labor Lunch	2024–2025
	Treasurer, Graduate Economic Association	2024–2025
	Mentor, Economics Mentoring Program	2023
	<i>Refereeing</i>	
	<i>American Economic Review, American Economic Review: Insights, Economic Journal, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Political Economy, Labour Economics, Management Science, PNAS, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Science Advances</i>	